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Dear editorial board members of *Ecology Letters*,

In addition to the author response letter that we made available alongside our revised manuscript, we wanted like to raise your attention concerning Reviewer 3's first comment, which did not appear very constructive to us. Indeed, in the absence of (1) clear bibliographic context (apart from a preprint) supporting the statements that are being stressed on the inadequacy to consider palaeoclimate as the only driver behind the asymmetry of the GABI – our working hypothesis, that our findings fail at supporting – and (2) any explicit suggestion(s) for improvement coming along the invitation to re-write the manuscript, such a comment appeared to us as more referring to personal opinions rather than actual scientific facts.

Thanks in advance for your understanding.
All the best,

Lucas Buffan, on behalf of my co-authors

